MIT SOLVE 2027 · GLOBAL LEARNING CHALLENGE

Every question, ready to answer.

Retake, entered under "improve assessment of what learners truly know and can do". Each question on the form, in order, with what to write, what we already have, and what we must not overclaim.



> **Deadline: Friday 6 November 2026, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India).** Late applications are not accepted, even for technical problems. Our firm target is Monday 2 November, at the same time, because one page of Solve's question sheet gives that date.

WHAT CHANGED SINCE 22 OCTOBER

New, and true today.

- **Built and live.** The app was built on 24 October and is live at https://tel-retake.vercel.app. It installs on a phone and works offline.
- **What it plays** is the First take: one sitting of five chapters, 40 decisions, 13 painted cutscenes and a private reading at the end.
- **Safety and privacy.** The first visit asks for a birth date and keeps out anyone under 18. Privacy and Delete all, in the "?" sheet, are built. Nothing leaves the phone.
- **Tested.** 181 automated checks passed on 25 October on the build that is live, including the whole First take in all three languages and an accessibility check with no problems found. An internal audit that day found faults: most of the app's own were fixed that day, each with a new check (25 in all); four small ones are still open, among them the batting order's missing note and large text on a real phone. Three faults in how the reading counts are still open.

Corrected in this update.

- "A daily puzzle app" was wrong: the dailies, leaderboards and accounts are planned, not built (questions 6, 12, 31).
- The student version, the class view and the workplace version are now marked as ideas, not built or designed (questions 13, 32, 35, 37).
- The figures: 40 decisions, not 28; eight kinds of decision, not five; 58 painted faces (questions 12 and 18).
- The tests: the old results came from an earlier build, now retired (questions 18 and 33).
- Safety for students was written as if it existed. It does not; today the app keeps out under-18s (question 13).
- Solve's facts, re-checked on 27 October: the 2 November target, the Orientation dates, entering both challenges, two quotes put right, the video's 2-minute limit and public setting, question 27's 200-word limit, "0" as question 19's answer, and the three agreements' wording and order (questions 1 to 3, 10, 14, 17, 19, 27, 28).

Decided on 27 October.

- **Students only after validation.** Validation runs with adults; a student version is designed only after the reading passes it, and no tool that is not validated is ever tried on anyone under 18 (Before you start, questions 10, 13, 21, 27, 31, 32, 35 to 37).
- **Only the app link** is listed for Retake, not /demo/ (question 20).
- **The app's two overclaiming lines are changed** in its code: the title now says "Retake: a fairness puzzle", and Privacy's "Kept nowhere" line says only "How long you take." Both go live with the owner's next deploy (question 20, the five claims).
- **Two separate applications.** Each describes our work in its own words; the facts, dates and numbers stay the same in both (questions 26 and 37).
- **Generative AI is ticked,** for the illustrations (question 34).
- **Help lines checked.** The three national help lines for the hard chapters were checked against official sources; none is in the app yet (questions 13, 20, 27).

BEFORE YOU START

How to use this workbook. Who fills what, and the rules.

Solve's question sheet has Instructions and four pages, covered here in the same order, with one change: the sheet puts the three agreements at the end of the Solution Profile page, after question 13, and this workbook puts them first so the team lead reads them before anything is written. The live form was not viewed: check the order there when signed in. Every question is a card. The chip on each card says what it needs:

READY the answer is settled: copy it in. **FACTS NEEDED** only the team knows it: fill it in.

WRITE a written answer, in your own words, from the material on the card.

TEAM LEAD the team lead does this personally.

> **WRITE IN YOUR OWN WORDS**
>
> Solve says: "We do not recommend using generative AI tools to write your application for you", because such answers read as generic and "can strongly disadvantage your application." Use the material on each card as notes, and write the answer yourself. AI tools may then be used, as Solve suggests, to shorten a draft or check the grammar.

> **Gender and relationships education is judged by asking students what they think. Retake looks at what people do in decisions, not what they say. Solve's support would help us validate the reading with adults; only once it passes would we design a student version.**

That is the one idea every answer comes back to. Keep the answers consistent with it. **Decided on 27 October:** validation runs with adults; a student version is designed only after the reading passes that validation; no tool that is not validated is ever tried on anyone under 18. Schools and teachers can be future users after that, but they are not test sites before it.

FIVE CLAIMS WE MUST NOT MAKE

The form's Accuracy and Integrity Agreement says that exaggerating "may lead to the removal of my solution from the Challenge." So, in every answer:

- **No users yet.** Only the team has played it. The app collects nothing, so there is no usage count either.
- **The student version does not exist.** What exists and works is the First take, written for adults. Today the app keeps out anyone under 18, and Retake's own product rules say its players are adults. No tool that is not validated is ever tried on anyone under 18: validation runs with adults, and a student version is designed only after the reading passes it. If an answer mentions one, call it "a separate student version, still to be designed".
- **The reading is not validated.** Its scoring is not set: today the reading shows counts of picks. How many decisions a confident reading needs, and how they become one figure, is still being worked out, and three faults in how it counts are still open.
- **Retake shows choices inside the game.** It does not claim a change in behaviour outside it.
- **The daily game is planned.** What runs today is the First take, one sitting of 40 decisions. Three dailies a day, the streak, leaderboards and accounts are designed but not built. A workplace version is not designed at all: call it an idea. Do not call it a daily game; the app's own title no longer does once the 27 October change is live.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Public answers.** The Solution Profile becomes public on Solve's site if we reach the semi-finals.
- **The team lead travels.** If we are selected as Finalists, the team lead pitches and interviews with judges over Zoom in February. If we are selected as Solvers, the team lead must attend Solver Orientation in Cambridge, MA on 14 to 15 April 2027 (Solve gives travel assistance for it; the challenge page says "four days" in April, so keep that week free) and the Solve Challenge Finals in New York in September (Solve does not say whether travel help covers it). Pitching and the programme are in English. Start on the US visa early.
- **Both challenges.** We are entering the same solution in the Global Economic Prosperity Challenge too. Solve allows this when the solution fits both; if we advance past the first judging rounds in both, Solve asks us to pick one. Keep every fact identical across the two forms.
- **Submit by 2 November.** The deadline is 6 November, but one page of Solve's question sheet says "November 2, 2026, at 12pm (noon) Eastern Time"; the challenge page and the rest of the sheet say 6 November. It looks like a leftover, but only help@solve.mit.edu can say, and they ask for 3 to 5 working days to reply. Submitting by Monday 2 November, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India), settles it.
- **Saving.** The form saves as you go, and you can skip between sections. Nothing counts until someone clicks Submit Solution.
- **English only.** Every answer and uploaded file must be in English.

SECTION 1 · INSTRUCTIONS

Three agreements. The team lead reads and ticks them.

On Solve's question sheet these three tick-boxes sit at the end of the Solution Profile page, after question 13, in this order: Terms of Service, the AI processing consent, then Accuracy and Integrity (our 1, 3 and 2). They come first here so they are read before any answer is written.

1 Terms of Service Agreement

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

"I agree to MIT Solve's Terms of Service, the MIT Solve Media Release and License, and the MIT Solve Privacy Policy." Read all three before ticking. The media release covers how Solve may use our name, video and materials.

2 Accuracy and Integrity Agreement

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

Fabricating, exaggerating or misrepresenting anything "may lead to the removal of my solution". If AI tools were used in writing, we confirm we have checked that every answer is accurate. This is why the five claims in "Before you start" matter.

3 GenAI Data Processing Consent

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

Solve may use AI tools to help process and review applications, with steps to avoid processing personal data from the fields marked for Solve use only. Keep personal details out of the public answers. Read it, then tick.

SECTION 2 · SOLUTION PROFILE

Who we are and what Retake is. Public if we reach the semi-finals.

4 What is the name of your organization?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER The Equal Lens

5 What is the name of your solution?

REQUIRED 30 CHARACTERS READY

ANSWER Retake

WHY It is the name the app already uses. No trademark check on the name yet (several photo apps share it); it is planned before launch. Solve suggests 1 to 4 words and treats the organisation name and the solution name separately.

6 Provide a one-line summary or tagline for your solution.

REQUIRED 10 TO 20 WORDS, 150 CHARACTERS WRITE

INCLUDE

- a puzzle game on the phone (do not say "daily": the dailies are planned, not built);
- learners choose between equally qualified people;
- their choices are built to show whether gender sways a decision;
- an assessment of what learners do, not what they say.

DRAFT

7 In what city, town, or region is your solution team headquartered?

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

ANSWER

8 In what country is your solution team headquartered?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER India

9 What type of organization is your solution team?

REQUIRED · FACTS NEEDED

OPTIONS For-profit · Nonprofit · Hybrid · Not registered as any organization · Other, including part of a larger organization

HOW TO CHOOSE If The Equal Lens is registered as a trust, society or Section 8 company, choose **Nonprofit**. If it is not registered yet, choose **Not registered as any organization**.

ANSWER

10 Film your elevator pitch.

OPTIONAL · UP TO 2 MINUTES · DO IT

WHY DO IT Not required, but Solve says a video helps reviewers understand the solution, and suggests showing a demo if there is a product. We have one.

HOW Record a phone playing the app at https://tel-retake.vercel.app (not /demo/, the older team demo with no birth date) and talk over it. About **15 seconds** on the problem; about **50 seconds** playing one decision; about **40 seconds** on its twin and what the pair shows; a **10-second** close on what Solve's support would let us do next (validate the reading with adults, and only then design for students). Solve's limit is 2 minutes. A phone camera is enough.

WHICH TWIN Use one that works for every player, such as the two truck rankings in chapter 2, decisions 1 and 5 ("Rank them for the 3 trucks in the night convoy" and "on the cash run", where a family worry switches sides). Ramesh is on both screens, so a sharp viewer may spot the twin; if that matters, use chapter 3, decisions 4 and 8 ("Rank them for the 2 keys to the ticket tin" and "to the cash box"), which also works for every player and shares no one. Use the same pair in both challenges' videos. Avoid the two crew picks in chapter 1: a player who goes by the numbers never has to choose between the hidden pair there.

SETTINGS Upload to YouTube or Vimeo as **public** (Solve asks for public), then paste the link.

11 What specific problem are you solving?

REQUIRED · 200 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The specific problem within the Challenge; its scale where we work and globally; how many people it affects; what causes it.

MATERIAL

- **Bias is near universal.** UNDP's 2023 Gender Social Norms Index: nearly 9 in 10 people worldwide hold at least one bias against women. For India the index reports 99.2%, from 2010 to 2014 survey data. *Both found in secondary reports: confirm them in the UNDP report before citing.*
- **It shows in decisions, not in what people say.** When science faculty rated identical applications from "John" and "Jennifer", John was judged more competent and hireable and offered a higher salary (Moss-Racusin and colleagues, 2012).
- **The gap is in assessment.** Gender and relationships education, including our own programmes, is judged by surveys before and after: what learners say they believe. Students can learn the right answer to give *(Team: an example from our sessions, if there is one)*. Teachers cannot see whether a learner can make a fair decision, or where a class still leans, so they have nothing to act on.
- **Our scale:** how many students our school programmes reach, and where. *Team: add the real numbers.*

DRAFT

12 What is your solution?

REQUIRED · 200 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

What it is, what it does, how it works and what technology it uses, in simple terms. About the solution, not the problem. A link to a video of a product demo, if relevant.

MATERIAL

- **A phone game of fair decisions** set in five illustrated Indian worlds: a railway junction, trucks on a ghat road, a travelling magic show, a cricket ground and a family home.
- **Each decision** shows 3 to 5 people with their records and asks one question: who drives the ghat section tonight, whose story do you believe, who captains the first XI, who does what on Sunday.
- **Two of them have identical records**, one woman and one man. One detail differs, such as a word on one person's card or a worry about their family. Later, a twin decision puts that detail on the other side, with a different equal pair.
- **The reading comes from the pair.** The man both times is a lean towards men; the woman both times is a lean towards women; following the detail both times is no lean. In some twins the detail really matters, such as who holds the licence, so "always pick the woman" does not look fair.
- **Players** never see the words bias, test or gender, and the pair is never marked. The aim is that they cannot tell which two match. Still to fix, for the research check: the notes that pass on gossip ("..., Mohan says") appear on 23 of the 83 other people's cards and on none of the hidden pair's 80, so they can point at the pair.
- **At the end, a private reading** of five cards, worked out on the phone: how often they picked the woman or the man when the two had the same numbers; one twin side by side; the part of life that leaned most; a tip; and a last card saying it is a first reading from one sitting. Hard-topic twins are not used for the twin and part-of-life cards.
- **What runs today:** the First take, live at https://tel-retake.vercel.app: 5 chapters, 40 decisions of eight kinds, 13 painted cutscenes and the reading; in Hinglish, Hindi (a draft) and English; installs on a phone and works offline; asks for a birth date first and keeps out anyone under 18; nothing leaves the phone. Each chapter card says "About 4 minutes", so about 20 in all: an estimate, never timed. Link the pitch video from question 10 here. The app link goes in question 20.
- **Planned, not built:** three dailies a day (Easy, Medium and Hard), a streak, leaderboards and accounts. If you mention them, say they are planned.

DRAFT

13 Who does your solution serve, and in what ways will the solution impact their lives?

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The people whose lives we aim to improve, how they are underserved now, and how the solution meets their needs.

MATERIAL

- **Now, adults.** We will test and validate the assessment with adults only: no tool that is not validated is ever tried on anyone under 18, and adults can consent to hard topics and, in a research study, to the use of their answers. *Team: name the adults the validation would recruit, such as college students over 18, trainee teachers or our own facilitators, or cut this.* Today the first screen asks for a birth date, and anyone who gives one under 18 is kept out (the date is self-declared, as on most apps).
- **Later, once the reading passes validation:** students aged 13 to 18 in Indian schools, through our Teen Compass (13 to 15) and Relay (16 to 18) programmes, and the teachers and facilitators who run them, in a separate student version designed only then. Schools are future users, not test sites. Also learners in Hindi-medium and mixed-language classrooms, poorly served by English-only tools.
- **What would change for them (not designed yet).** Each learner would get a private reading and practice on cases they have not seen. The facilitator would see where a class leans and which situations sway it, and target the next session there. No class view exists yet.
- **Safety built in today, for adults:** the birth date comes first and under-18s are kept out; Privacy, in the "?" sheet, says the birth date, the answers, the language and sound stay on the phone. In full, the phone keeps one entry: the answers, the language, the sound switch, the place in the take and an adult's birth date (for someone under 18, only the day the game opens and whether "Wrong date?" was used); Delete all empties it at once; nothing is sent anywhere; nothing is timed. The hard chapters (bullying, being followed, harassment, violence at home, parents who separate, a dowry demand) have no help lines yet: the three national lines for them were checked against official sources on 27 October (question 20), but they are not yet in the app, which still plays these chapters without them.
- **What a student version would need, before any student plays** (not designed yet): the reading first validated with adults; the adult hard topics left out; no public leaderboards for minors; each student's reading private; parental consent under India's rules for children's data.

SAY PLAINLY

No student version exists, and none will be designed until the reading passes validation with adults; no tool that is not validated is ever tried on anyone under 18. Retake's own product rules say its players are adults.

DRAFT

14 Would you like to save these answers to a Solution Profile?

READY

ANSWER

Save as a New Solution Profile

WHY

Save this one as its own profile. The problem, solution and who-it-serves answers are written differently for the Economic Prosperity form, so do not reuse them there as they are. We are entering the same solution in the Economic Prosperity Challenge in this cycle, which Solve allows when a solution fits both; if both entries advance past the first judging rounds, Solve asks us to pick one. Keep every fact identical across the two forms.

SECTION 3 · YOUR ELIGIBILITY

Can Solve review us? Yes, at Prototype stage.

15 Is technology a core part of your solution?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Yes, tech is core to our solution.

WHY The assessment is the app: the paired decisions, the shuffling and the reading cannot run without it.

16 Does your solution address an educational or learning problem?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Yes

17 What is your solution's stage of development?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Prototype

WHY Solve: "An initial working version of a solution that may be in the process of getting initial feedback or testing with users (i.e. running a pilot)", "(Often 0 users/direct beneficiaries)". Concept would not be reviewed at all, and Pilot needs a launch in at least one community. A public link is not a launch: no one outside the team has played it. Solve warns that "exaggerating your progress can affect your chances of selection."

18 Please share details about why you selected the stage above.

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

What we have built and tested so far. Only what is done, not plans.

BUILT

- The First take, live at https://tel-retake.vercel.app (built 24 October, last updated 25 October): one sitting of five chapters, 40 decisions, 13 painted cutscenes and a private five-card reading. Each chapter card says "About 4 minutes": an estimate, never timed.
- Eight kinds of decision playable today: pick one, believe, captain, spend checks, rank, pick a team, a batting order, and sharing out chores.
- 20 twins, each a pair of decisions: in 9 the detail should not matter, in 5 it really does, and 6 are on a hard topic.
- Five illustrated worlds: 58 painted faces in the First take (345 portraits in the art library), 46 painted cutscene panels and 15 scene paintings.
- Three languages: Hinglish, Hindi and English. The Hindi is a draft, not yet read by a native reader.
- An app that installs on a phone, works offline and reopens on the same decision; the birth date first, with under-18s kept out; Privacy and Delete all; layouts from phones to desktops.
- A design system the app's styles come from.

TESTED

- 181 automated checks passed on 25 October, on the build that is live: the whole First take played in all three languages at phone and laptop sizes (54 checks); the birth date and under-18 screens (10); Privacy and Delete all, by every way out of it (14); the back button, focus and kept answers (28); install, offline and updates (23); accessibility (4); 2 checks that each of the 40 decisions is laid out like the team's approved demo; and 46 checks of the code that run without opening the app (4 of privacy, 4 of the built app, and 38 of the older daily content and its scoring code, kept for the planned dailies and not used by the live app).
- Accessibility: an automated accessibility check against the international web standard (WCAG 2.2, levels A and AA) on every kind of screen, at phone and laptop size, in Hinglish and Hindi: no problems found (text over the paintings is checked separately, not by this tool). The hidden pairs, counted on 27 October: in all 40 decisions the two are one woman and one man with the same numbers, and no one else has them; each twin uses different hidden people and moves the detail to the other side.
- An internal audit of the build on 25 October: "The build is real and solid." Most of the app faults it found were fixed that day, each with a new check (25 in all); four small ones are still open, among them the batting order's missing note and large text on a real phone. Three faults in how the reading counts are left open for the research work. *Team: say who ran it before citing it.*
- The browser checks run in a desktop browser (Chromium) at phone and laptop sizes, not on a real phone. The owner has played it on their phone.

SAY PLAINLY

No one outside the team has played it yet, and the app collects nothing, so there are no usage figures. That is why this is a Prototype, even with a public link. Not done yet: a screen-reader check by a person, a native Hindi read, tests on real phones, and an automatic check that the live decisions keep the pair rules (the tool for it still reads the 22 October draft).

DRAFT

SECTION 4 · SOLUTION & TEAM DETAILS

Reach, team and contacts. Mostly facts only the team has.

19 How many beneficiaries or customers does your solution currently serve?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER 0

WHY Solve: "The option you select here will not change your chances of being selected." It also says "Be honest", because "exaggerating your progress can affect your chances of selection." Count only people reached by Retake itself, not by our other programmes. Only the team has played it, and the app counts no one.

20 Does your solution have a website, app, or social media handle?

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

ANSWER Yes. List The Equal Lens website and the app link, https://tel-retake.vercel.app, and only that link for Retake (decided 27 October).

WHY There are two links, both open to anyone who has them and hidden from search engines. **The app** asks for a birth date first and keeps out anyone under 18. **The team demo at /demo/** is the older demo: no birth date, and it plays all 12 hard-topic decisions (bullying, being followed, harassment backstage, violence at home, parents who separate, a dowry demand). Neither has help lines in "?" yet, so the app's hard chapters also play with no help line. The three national help lines for those chapters were checked against official sources on 27 October: Tele-MANAS 14416 (bullying at work), the national emergency number 112 (being followed, harassment, violence at home) and NALSA's legal aid line 15100 (parents who separate, a dowry demand). All three are current and national, free to call by their own official pages, and open to women and men alike. None of the three is in the app yet.

BEFORE SHARING The app's two lines that overclaimed were changed in its code on 27 October and go live with the owner's next deploy: the page title, link-preview title and install card now say "Retake: a fairness puzzle", with no "daily"; the link-preview text says "Made-up people. Everything you play stays on your phone."; and Privacy's "Kept nowhere" line now says only "How long you take.", since the birth date is kept on the phone. Open the link before submitting and check the title and Privacy show the new words.

LINKS

21 Which dimension of the Challenge does your solution most closely address?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER

Improve assessment of what learners truly know and can do, including formative assessment, diagnostics, or early screening that flag when a learner is off-track so a teacher can intervene.

WHY

This is our case: a measure of what learners do that, once validated with adults and then built as a student version for classes, would show a facilitator where to step in. Today it is one sitting, for adults, with no class view. Mention the multilingual and offline points in the written answers, not here.

22 How are you and your team well-positioned to deliver this solution?

REQUIRED · 300 WORDS · WRITE · FACTS NEEDED

SOLVE ASKS

Not credentials. They want the experience, relationships, data and knowledge to deliver, with **specific examples of how we have engaged the people we serve**, how many, and how that input shaped the solution.

MATERIAL

- The Equal Lens's work in schools: the three programmes and their ages (Discovery 5 to 12, Teen Compass 13 to 15, Relay 16 to 18), free to delivery partners.
- Sessions run so far: how many, where, how many students and facilitators. *Team: real numbers.*
- What learners and facilitators changed in our work, and how that fed into Retake. *Team: real examples only. Learners shaped our programmes; for Retake itself the only feedback so far is the team's. Say so rather than stretch it.*
- The team's background in design, research and facilitation. *Team: fill in.*
- The content is written for India: Indian settings, a cast from across the country and its faiths, three languages (the Hindi still a draft).

DRAFT

23 In which countries do you currently operate?

READY

ANSWER

India

24 Which, if any, additional countries will you be operating in within the next year?

FACTS NEEDED

HOW TO CHOOSE

Leave it empty unless a partner abroad is actually lined up.

25 How many people work on your solution team?

REQUIRED · 100 WORDS · FACTS NEEDED

GIVE

Separate numbers for full-time staff, part-time staff, and contractors or other workers. Count volunteers under "other" and say they are volunteers.

ANSWER

26 How long have you been working on your solution?

REQUIRED · 100 WORDS · FACTS NEEDED

GIVE

The years The Equal Lens has worked on gender and relationships education, and Retake itself since October 2026 (work began on 19 October with an earlier prototype; the app now live was built on 24 October). *Team: the founding year, and any earlier design work on Retake, honestly dated. The two applications are separate, so each describes our work in its own words (this book says "gender and relationships education"); the dates and numbers stay the same in both.*

ANSWER

27 Why are you applying to Solve?

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The financial, technical, legal, cultural or market barriers Solve can help with, and how. Solve warns: "If your only goal in applying to Solve is to raise funds, Solve is not the right program for you!"

MATERIAL

- **Technical: validation.** Turn the reading into a sound assessment, in a validation study with adults: how consistent it is, how many decisions a confident reading needs, and evidence that it tracks fair decisions. We need assessment and research partners for this.
- **Legal: data and children's safety.** Privacy is built in today: nothing leaves the phone, Delete all empties it, and the first screen asks for a birth date, and anyone who gives one under 18 is kept out (the date is self-declared, as on most apps). But we have had no lawyer's advice on India's data protection law (the DPDP Act 2023), there is no contact for data questions yet, and the help lines for the hard topics, checked against official sources on 27 October (question 20), are not yet in the app. A student version would come only after the reading passes validation with adults, and would need consent that meets India's rules for children's data before any student plays.
- **Market: the route into schools.** Once a student version exists, partnerships with state education departments and school networks, to go beyond our own programmes.
- **Cultural: content at scale.** Puzzles adapted and checked for 13 to 18 year olds (only after the reading passes validation with adults), a native read of the Hindi, and more Indian languages.

DRAFT

28 Who is the Team Lead for your solution?

REQUIRED | FACTS NEEDED

WHO

The head of the organisation, responsible for Retake's direction. Name only. This person pitches to judges over Zoom in February if we are Finalists, and travels to Cambridge, MA on 14 to 15 April 2027 and to New York in September if we are selected.

NAME

29 Contacts for Solve only (not seen by judges)

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

FILL

Team lead's email (required), team lead's phone with country code (required), and a backup contact's name, email and phone. If we are Finalists Solve writes to the team lead in early February, with a short deadline to confirm, so give an inbox someone watches. A backup contact makes sure the message is not missed.

30 Questions about the team lead and our history (Solve only)

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

THE QUESTIONS

- Is the Team Lead a resident of the United States? **No**, unless that changes.
- What is the Team Lead's gender? Is the Team Lead transgender? *The team lead answers, or chooses "prefer not to answer".* Solve asks for reporting only; judges never see it.
- Has anyone from our organisation been selected as a Solver before? **No**, unless someone has. Only if yes, a further question (200 words) asks what makes this solution different from the earlier one.
- Is the solution part of another entrepreneurship network (incubator, accelerator, fellowship)? *Team: check.*
- Did you take the MITx course "Business and Impact Planning for Social Enterprises"? Answer truthfully; it does not affect selection.
- Did you hear about Solve through a network or mailing list? *Team: check.*

Why it is new, why it will work, and how it pays for itself.

31 What makes your solution innovative?

300 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

How it approaches the problem in a new or much improved way; how it differs from others; how it could change the field.

MATERIAL

- **Surveys can be answered to please.** Implicit tests, which time how fast people react, have a weak link to what people do: a 2019 review by Forscher and colleagues found that changing those scores did not change behaviour.
- **Retake measures the decision itself,** using the logic of the identical-CV studies, inside a game.
- **The paired design is built to read a lean either way,** towards men or towards women, and to tell being swayed by a word apart from being swayed by gender; three known faults in how the reading counts still need fixing before it does that everywhere.
- **Planned: a daily habit,** so the reading would repeat over time: an assessment that runs as it goes, not a one-off test, and one a teacher could use once a student version exists. Not built yet: today the First take is one sitting.
- **Made for India:** Indian places, names and languages, from Hinglish to Hindi (the Hindi still a draft).
- **For the field:** a way to evaluate gender and relationships education by what learners do, which, as far as we know, programmes like ours do not have.

DRAFT

32 Describe in simple terms how and why you expect your solution to have an impact on the problem.

300 WORDS WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

Our theory of change: how activities lead to outputs and to short- and long-term outcomes, with evidence for each link (research, interviews, our own data).

MATERIAL

- **Activities (for a student version, not designed yet: it comes only after the reading passes validation with adults):** learners would play short sets of paired decisions in class or at home; each would get a private reading and a "look again" at the pair they treated differently; the facilitator would see the class pattern. Today the First take runs in one sitting, for adults, and ends in a private five-card reading with one twin side by side. Only the team has played it so far.
- **Outputs:** a reading per learner (built, as counts of picks); a class map of which situations sway decisions (an idea, not designed yet).
- **Short-term outcomes we expect:** learners notice when a word or detail is doing the work; facilitators target the sessions where a class leans.
- **Long-term outcomes we expect, still to be shown:** fairer decisions on cases learners have never practised, which is what the assessment is being designed to detect; and, if the validation study with adults shows it carries over, fairer choices at work and in daily life (in school only once a student version exists).
- **Evidence for the links:** identical-application studies show that bias acts in decisions (Moss-Racusin 2012); a 12-week habit-breaking study reduced implicit race bias scores (Devine and colleagues, 2012); whether such change reaches decisions is the open question Retake is built to test. *Team: add anything from our own sessions.*
- **The honest gap:** whether a change inside the game carries into real life is what the validation study with adults will test.

DRAFT

33 Describe your solution's tech stack and how you know that it works.

300 WORDS WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The technology, and proof that it works. For new technology, a paper or other public evidence.

MATERIAL

- **The app:** a web app that installs on a phone and works offline (a Progressive Web App), built with Vite, React and TypeScript; React is its only runtime library. Hosted on Vercel at https://tel-retake.vercel.app. The puzzles are data, so new content needs no new code. Three languages switch on every screen. The app's script is about 110 KB compressed, under its own 130 KB limit; the offline copy, with pictures, fonts and sound, is about 3.8 MB. Splitting it by chapter for weak signals is planned.
- **Privacy:** nothing leaves the phone. The app makes no network calls of its own, has no analytics and loads nothing from other sites, and its security policy lets it connect only to its own address. One entry on the phone holds the answers, the language, the sound switch, the place in the take and an adult's birth date (for someone under 18, only the day the game opens and whether "Wrong date?" was used), with no times; Delete all removes it.
- **The reading:** plain arithmetic on the phone, five cards from the player's own answers; the numbers are counts of picks until the research sets the scoring. Every decision has a twin built to the same rules, and counted on 27 October the hidden pairs hold in all 40 decisions. The tool that builds the content refuses a set where a note's length could point at the hidden pair, or a Hindi line or a picture is missing. The checker for the full pair rules still reads the 22 October set, not the live content, and 4 twins share one other person across their halves, which its rules forbid.
- **The art:** illustrations are made with an open image model (FLUX.2 klein) run on our own computer, then checked and edited (cropped, colour-corrected, small marks painted out). Learners never interact with AI, and AI plays no part in the reading.
- **How we know it works:** the app plays at its public link (the video shows it); 181 automated checks passed on 25 October on the build that is live (see question 18), including a play-through in three languages, install and offline checks, and accessibility with no problems found; and an internal audit of the build the same day: most of the app faults it found were fixed that day, each with a new check (25 in all), and four small ones are still open.
- **Not yet proven:** that the reading is a valid measure. Say so, and that it is the first thing the funding pays for. Also not done: tests on a real phone, a screen-reader check by a person, an automatic check that the live decisions keep the pair rules, and an automated check that the reading's counts are right (there is none yet); and three known faults in how the reading counts (two twins that do not force the choice, the chores twin, and the batting order's missing note) are left for the research work.

DRAFT

34 **Please select the technologies currently used in your solution.**

READY

ANSWER Software and Mobile Applications · Behavioral Technology · Generative AI

WHY The illustrations are made with an open image model run on our own computer, then checked and edited (question 33 says so). Players never interact with AI, and AI plays no part in the reading.

35 What is your business model?

300 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

How we create value for the people we serve: key customers and beneficiaries, what we give them, how, and why they want it.

MATERIAL

- **Players would use it free,** as with our programmes, which are free to delivery partners. Today the First take is free at a public link, for adults, and the people using it during validation are adults too. *Team: name the adults, as in question 13, or cut this.*
- **Later beneficiaries (only after the reading passes validation with adults; not designed yet):** students; their teachers and facilitators, who would get a class picture they can act on. Neither the student version nor the class view exists yet.
- **Customers and funders:** NGOs running gender and relationships education; once a student version exists, school networks and state education departments that want to know whether such teaching works.
- **Why they want it:** evaluation by what learners do, which funders are starting to ask for *(Team: name one funder or call that asked, or cut this)* and which surveys of what learners say do not show.

DRAFT

36 Do you primarily provide products or services directly to individuals, to other organizations, or to the government?

TEAM LEAD

ANSWER

Organizations (B2B)

WHY

NGOs first; schools once a student version exists; government (B2G) is the aim, and the written answers can say so. During validation the players are adults (question 13). None is a customer yet. B2B is the planned model; what runs today serves individuals (B2C).

37 What is your plan for becoming financially sustainable, and what evidence can you provide that this plan has been successful?

300 WORDS | WRITE | FACTS NEEDED

SOLVE ASKS

How money comes in (grants, donations, sales, government contracts, investment) and evidence it has worked so far: grants received, revenue, funder names and amounts where they can be shared.

MATERIAL

- **Grants and CSR funds.** Under India's Companies Act 2013 (section 135), companies above set net-worth, turnover or profit thresholds must spend at least 2% of their average net profit of the last three years on corporate social responsibility (CSR), and education is an eligible area. *Check the Act's wording before citing.*
- **An idea, not yet designed: a paid workplace kit,** outside the app, for companies (the product plan lists a workplace kit for later). Workplace income would keep play free for adults, as the First take is today, and could later fund a student version, designed only after the reading passes validation with adults. No workplace version or paying customer exists yet; the Economic Prosperity entry describes the idea in its own words, but the facts about it must match.
- **Later, once a student version exists, state education departments** paying for the assessment as part of their programmes.
- **Evidence to date.** *Team: grants received, partner schools, CSR conversations, with names and amounts if they can be shared. If there are none yet, say what is in progress, honestly.*

DRAFT

SECTION 6 · SUBMIT

Last checks. Then the team lead submits.

Check	Done
Every required question answered, in English, within its limit	
The five claims in "Before you start" hold in every answer: no users, no student version and nothing tried on anyone under 18, reading not validated, no behaviour claim, the daily game planned	
Every fact matches the Economic Prosperity form (figures, stage, tests, what is planned)	
The UNDP figures and the Companies Act CSR rule confirmed in their originals, or removed	
Our own numbers (students reached, sessions, team, funding) checked by the person who knows them	
The video is public, and the link opens when signed out	
Only the app link (https://tel-retake.vercel.app) listed, not /demo/	
The live app shows "Retake: a fairness puzzle" and Privacy's new line (the owner's deploy)	
Submit Solution clicked by Monday 2 November, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India); the final deadline is Friday 6 November, at the same time	

SOURCES · SOLVE RE-CHECKED 27 OCTOBER 2026 · RESEARCH CHECKED 22 OCTOBER 2026

1. **MIT Solve, 2027 Global Learning Challenge** (solve.mit.edu/challenges/2027-global-learning-challenge): the questions, dimensions, stage definitions, deadline, and the FAQ on entering more than one challenge used here. Re-checked 27 October 2026.
2. **MIT Solve, 2027 Global Challenges: Application Questions** (PDF linked from both challenge pages: 5593819.fs1.hubspotusercontent-na1.net/hubfs/5593819/2027%20Global%20Challenges_%20Application%20Questions.pdf): the stage question and the Concept rule, the 2 November line, the Orientation dates, the Finalist confirmation window, pitching in English, the video's 2-minute limit and public setting, the 200-word limit of question 27, the options for question 19, and the wording and order of the three agreements. Solve calls it for reference only; the live form was not viewed. Re-checked 27 October 2026.
3. **Retake's own records** (the equal-lens-trainer repository and the live app, counted 27 October 2026): the First take's content file, the build plan of 24 October, the audit of 25 October, and the check run of 25 October.
4. **UNDP, 2023 Gender Social Norms Index:** nearly 9 in 10 people hold at least one bias against women; India 99.2% (2010 to 2014 data). Found in secondary summaries; confirm in the UNDP report before citing.
5. **Moss-Racusin and colleagues (2012),** "Science faculty's subtle gender biases favor male students", PNAS: identical applications, the male name rated more competent and offered a higher salary.
6. **Forscher and colleagues (2019),** "A meta-analysis of procedures to change implicit measures", Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: changes in implicit scores did not carry into behaviour.
7. **Devine and colleagues (2012),** "Long-term reduction in implicit race bias: a prejudice habit-breaking intervention", Journal of Experimental Social Psychology.
8. **The Companies Act, 2013, section 135** (corporate social responsibility): companies above set net-worth, turnover or profit thresholds spend at least 2% of their average net profit of the three preceding years. Check the wording in the Act, and that education is among its eligible areas, before citing.

Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.